# Rooftop Encounters

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Sleepless Domain (Webcomic)

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Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

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# Rooftop Encounters

by silveradept

## Summary

Team She-Ra is chasing one of their more persistent opponents on the rooftops, only to discover the enemy they've been chasing is closer to Adora's heart than she would have thought.

## Notes

See the end of the work for notes

She'd been chasing the girl in purple all night, powering through wave after wave of the monsters in the streets. The barrier was still holding, even if it was definitely more polka dot than she cared for. Her team was still keeping up with the chase, even as they fired arrows and sparkle bombs into the groups of monsters fighting other teams to help them out. Rounding a corner and jumping up to the top of a building, She-Ra came to a stop close enough to the girl in purple to finally get a good look at her.

"Catra?" she said, not wanting to believe what she was seeing.

"Oh, *hey*, Adora," the other girl said, turning to face her. The mischievous eyes that Adora had been looking at since they both became magical girls had been replaced with the same kind of glow the inky monsters laying siege to the barrier and the magical girl teams had. "So glad you could join me tonight."

"What are you *doing*, Catra?" She-Ra demanded.

"I thought it was obvious, Adora," Catra purred. "I'm being your villain."

"What?"

"You can't be the best magical girl unless you've got a proper villain to defeat," Catra smirked. "Not that you will, but it's no fun for either of us unless you feel like you have some hope."

"She-Ra!" Bow and Glimmer scrambled up and aimed their weapons at Catra. "Who is this?"

"She's…was one of my former teammates," Adora said.

"You don't sound too broken up about it," Catra teased. "I thought we were supposed to do this together. Did she tell you about how she should have died already?" Another batch of monsters sprang up from the rooftop underneath them. Glimmer and Bow struck and shot at them, driving them back toward the edge and destroying a couple of them.

"Catra, please, stop this," Adora pleaded, cleaving through the monsters around her with her sword.

"Why should I listen to you?" Catra's eye sockets narrowed. "You *abandoned* me, Adora. I burnt out every last bit of my magical girl power to keep you alive, and you didn't even bother to thank me for it. You just kept being She-Ra, you found yourself another team, and you left me behind. Guess our friendship wasn't really as strong as I thought it was."

"I wanted to see you!" Adora shouted back. "I tried to see you, but you told me you didn't want to see me. You said I needed to go back and be the hero we both wanted me to be. I don't know what you are, but you're not her. The *real* Catra would never have turned herself into a monster like this!"

"That's the funny thing, Adora," Catra said, flexing the claws at the end of her fingers. "Once you've had a taste of power, you'll do almost *anything* to get it back. But this time, I'm not staying in your shadow. I'm already more powerful than you and your team, so I've decided to return the favor and stop caring about you." Catra leapt to the edge of the rooftop.

"Wait!" Adora shouted. "Catra, if you're still in there, I need you to fight! I haven't forgotten you! I'm sorry that I couldn't be there more for you. It's… it's really hard doing this again. But we both said we'd keep fighting for as long as we had each other. I'm still fighting! The Catra I know wouldn't give up like this."

"Who said anything about giving up?" Catra said, chuckling. "I'm going to keep fighting, Adora, and I'm going to keep winning, too. You're still shackled by rules that someone else told you and you never thought to question. You're still dreaming, Adora. If you want to understand the truth, you have to wake up."

Bow stabbed a monster with one of his arrows, then turned, nocked, and fired it at Catra in a single smooth motion. The arrow buried itself deeply into Catra's head, before she started laughing

and dissolved into a pile of inky ooze, the arrow itself eaten completely by the substance.

"I'm sure you thought that was clever," another Catra said from the other side of the roof. "You're all too slow to put up any kind of fight," she added, hopping down to the rooftop. Glimmer summoned a sparkle bomb and flung it at the new Catra, who sank into the roof to avoid it, even as Glimmer tried to control the bomb so it would sink into the roof in hopes that the explosion might destroy this Catra's body.

"You see, Adora," a third Catra said from the same place the first had been, "you're not even awake enough to know if any of this is real." She smiled again. "I've had enough fun for tonight. When you decide to get serious, maybe I'll let you find me again."

With a final, powerful leap, Catra soared into the distance, well out of sight. Glimmer grabbed them both and teleported them to the place where Catra should have landed, but there was no sign of her.

"Catra," Adora said, sinking to her knees as the announcement began to play for the 2 A.M. warning, the sign there would be no more attacks that night. "What happened to her?"

"Whatever it is, we'll fight it together," Glimmer said.

"There's a possibility we can figure out how to separate the essence of the monsters from her," Bow said. "If she's being used as a host, we still have a chance to rescue her. We're going to need a lot of monster stuff to run the experiments with, though."

"You think the other teams will give us theirs?" Adora asked.

"I'll bet if we make it a competition, all of those image-obsessed teams will provide us with more than we will ever need," Glimmer said. "We're still going to be the top team, of course."

Bow and Adora looked at each other and started laughing at Homers enthusiasm. Adora knew Catra was still inside whatever it

was that had taken her shape. She had to keep her hope so that she wouldn't miss her opportunity to bring her best friend back and destroy that evil inky presence for good.

"See you all at school later," Adora said, yawning. "Time for me to go to sleep."

End Notes

I struggled a little trying to signpost the idea that this Catra is a mix of third season "I've thrown the portal switch, let the world burn" Catra and Tessa's story arc in Sleepless Domain, so she's a little more confrontational with Adora than Tessa has been with Undine to this point, and Adora's supposed to be a bit of herself and Undine, both who got thrust into the limelight because of their past and who are struggling a bit to find another good team to work with and who still have unresolved issues about the way their past has been and how their friends treated them. All that decided to come to mind was this single encounter, but I hope it worked well for you.

(If you're coming from She-Ra and want to know about Sleepless Domain, it's a webcomic at https://www.sleeplessdomain.com. Magical girls and deep secrets abound. If you're coming from the other direction, She-Ra's on Netflix. Magical girls and deep secrets abound.)

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